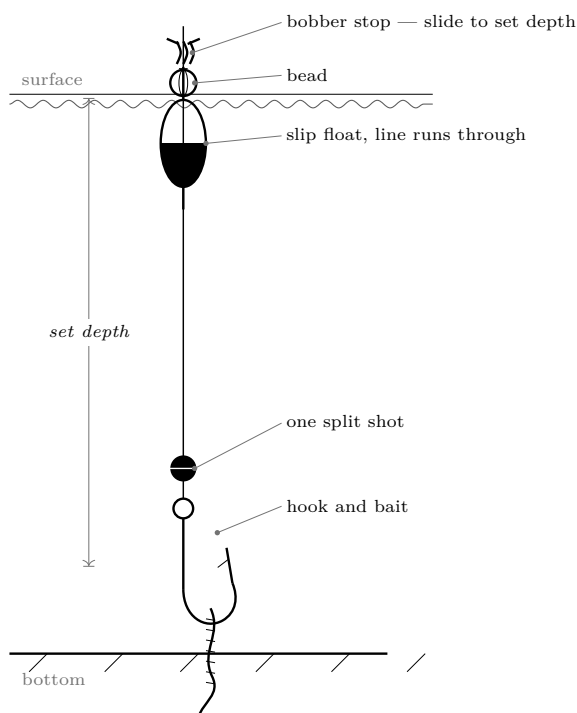


Slip Bobber

Hold a live bait at an exact depth, in any depth of water

The first rig to learn and the last one to give up



What it does	The float slides freely on the line until it hits the stop knot. You can fish 20 ft down and still reel the float to the rod tip to cast.
Why it matters	A fixed bobber can only fish as deep as your rod is long. A slip float has no such limit, which is the whole reason it exists.
Components	Bobber stop (thread or rubber), small bead, slip float, one or two split shot, hook.
Hook	Size 8–10 for panfish, 4–6 for crappie on a minnow, 1/0 for bass or walleye on a leech.
Line	4 lb for panfish; 6–8 lb for bass and walleye.
Catches	Bluegill, pumpkinseed, crappie, perch, largemouth, walleye, pike.

Build it

1. Thread the **bobber stop** onto the main line and slide it up. Tighten it enough to hold but loose enough to slide when you pull — this is what you will adjust all day.
2. Thread the **bead**. Its only job is to stop the small stop knot from pulling through the float's hole.
3. Thread the **float**, top end first.
4. Pinch on **split shot** 8–12 in above where the hook will be. Enough weight that the float sits upright with only its tip showing — an over-floated bobber cannot signal a bite.
5. Tie on the **hook** with an improved clinch knot, *see the **knots** sheet*.

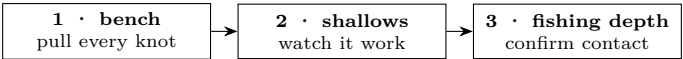
Fish it

Set the depth	Bait should ride just above whatever the fish are holding on — the weed tops, the bottom, the school. Fish look up far more readily than down. Start a foot above and work down.
Read it	A bluegill takes the float sideways and down in small taps. A crappie lifts it and lays it flat — that is a fish swimming up with the bait, and it is a bite. Walleye pull it under slowly and steadily.
Set the hook	Reel the slack, then sweep. Do not snap a rod at a crappie, <i>see the Black Crappie sheet</i> .
Adjust	A float that lies flat and stays flat is too deep — the bait is on the bottom. Slide the stop down.

When to use it

Any time you know the depth and want the bait to stay there: over a weed edge, over a crappie school suspended at 14 ft, over a bluegill bed, or with a big sucker over a weed flat for pike. It is the most controllable live-bait presentation there is, and it is the easiest rig in this guide to hand to a beginner.

Prove the rig



Bench test	Slide the stop through every rod guide, pull the hook knot, and measure stop-to-hook depth against the rod or a tape.
Water test	Set it two feet deep beside the boat: line must pass through the float until the stop seats and the float stands upright.
Proof at depth	After the cast, time the float seating; failure to stand means bottom contact, fouling, or insufficient shot.
If it fails	Float lies flat: add shot incrementally. Stop slips: retie or double it. Bait buries in weed: shorten set depth six inches. Change one variable, repeat the same cast or drop, and keep the first setting that restores the expected proof.

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